

**⚠ SIMULATED PROJECT: FICTIONAL COMPANY, CREATED FOR PORTFOLIO AND LEARNING PURPOSES**

Cobbleway Home Services Ltd is not a real business. Names, dates, budgets and results are invented to practise project-management methods from my MSc studies. Nothing here describes a real client or real outcomes.

# Closure report and lessons learned

Project Compass: CRM implementation • Cobbleway Home Services Ltd (fictional)

|                 |                                                                                    |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document        | End-project report and lessons learned, v1.0                                       |
| Date            | 16 Jun 2026 (M7 Project closed)                                                    |
| Sponsor         | Helen Marsh (fictional)                                                            |
| Project manager | Chidera Ikenna-Obi (simulated role, MSc practice project)                          |
| Status          | Closed. Handed over to business as usual (owner: Dave Pearson, Operations Manager) |

## 1. Summary

The CRM went live on 27 May 2026, 4 working days after the 20 May 2026 baseline and inside the one-week time tolerance. Final cost was £34,430 against a £36,500 approved budget (£33,000 base plus £3,500 contingency): £1,430 of contingency was used and £2,070 was returned. All 8 Must requirements were delivered; 4 of 5 Should requirements were delivered in full and 1 in part. The main cause of delay was poor legacy data quality (issue I01).

| Dimension | Final RAG | Comment                                                  |
|-----------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Schedule  | Amber     | Go-live +4 working days; within tolerance                |
| Cost      | Amber     | £1,430 over base budget; within contingency              |
| Scope     | Green     | All Musts delivered; two Could items deferred to backlog |
| Quality   | Green     | UAT passed; one defect (I04) fixed before go-live        |

## 2. Performance against objectives

| #  | Objective                                   | Result (simulated)                                          | Met?      |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| O1 | Go live by 20 May 2026                      | Live 27 May 2026 (+4 wd, within tolerance)                  | Partly    |
| O2 | Within £36,500                              | £34,430                                                     | Yes       |
| O3 | All Must requirements                       | 8 of 8 delivered                                            | Yes       |
| O4 | 100% of new enquiries in CRM within 2 weeks | Met in hypercare week 2 (CRM report vs call log)            | Yes       |
| O5 | Quote turnaround 2 days within 6 months     | 2.8 days average in first 3 weeks; review at 3 and 6 months | Too early |

## 3. Schedule performance

| Milestone                             | Baseline    | Actual      | Variance (wd) |
|---------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|---------------|
| M1 Charter and business case approved | 11 Mar 2026 | 11 Mar 2026 | +0            |
| M2 Requirements signed off            | 24 Mar 2026 | 24 Mar 2026 | +0            |

| Milestone                                | Baseline    | Actual      | Variance (wd) |
|------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|---------------|
| M3 Supplier selected and contract signed | 07 Apr 2026 | 07 Apr 2026 | +0            |
| M4 Configuration complete                | 12 May 2026 | 12 May 2026 | +0            |
| M5 Go/no-go decision                     | 18 May 2026 | 22 May 2026 | +4            |
| M6 Go-live                               | 20 May 2026 | 27 May 2026 | +4            |
| M7 Project closed                        | 10 Jun 2026 | 16 Jun 2026 | +4            |

## 4. Cost performance

| Category                               | Budget         | Final actual   | Variance       |
|----------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| CRM licences (18 users, year 1)        | £6,800         | £6,800         | +£0            |
| Supplier configuration and integration | £9,500         | £10,400        | +£900          |
| Data migration and cleansing           | £4,200         | £4,900         | +£700          |
| Training and materials                 | £3,000         | £2,650         | -£350          |
| Internal staff time (backfill)         | £6,000         | £6,300         | +£300          |
| Hardware (6 rugged tablets and cases)  | £3,500         | £3,380         | -£120          |
| <b>Total (base budget)</b>             | <b>£33,000</b> | <b>£34,430</b> | <b>+£1,430</b> |

Overruns came from CR01 (paid accounting connector, £900), extra supplier de-duplication (£700) and extra staff backfill during cleansing (£300). Training came in £350 under budget because sessions were run in-house by the champions.

## 5. Scope delivered

| ID     | Priority | Requirement                                                                     | Outcome                                             |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| REQ-01 | Must     | Single customer record holding contacts, properties, appliances and job history | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-02 | Must     | Log enquiries from phone, email and the website form in one queue               | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-03 | Must     | Create and send quotes from templates, with VAT calculated correctly            | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-04 | Must     | Sales pipeline with stages and automatic follow-up tasks                        | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-05 | Must     | Job records linked to customer and quote, assignable to an engineer             | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-06 | Must     | Mobile access for engineers: job details, notes, photos and customer sign-off   | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-07 | Must     | Migrate active customers (last 6 years) with duplicates removed                 | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-08 | Must     | Role-based access and UK GDPR-aligned retention rules                           | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-09 | Should   | Automated annual boiler-service reminders by email and SMS                      | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-10 | Should   | Sync invoices and customers with the existing accounting package                | Partly delivered (one-way sync; two-way in backlog) |
| REQ-11 | Should   | Log emails against the customer record                                          | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-12 | Should   | Management reports: pipeline value, conversion rate, quote turnaround           | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-13 | Should   | Offline mode for the mobile app in low-signal areas                             | Delivered                                           |
| REQ-14 | Could    | Customer online booking portal                                                  | Deferred to backlog                                 |
| REQ-15 | Could    | Post-job customer satisfaction survey                                           | Delivered                                           |

| ID     | Priority | Requirement        | Outcome             |
|--------|----------|--------------------|---------------------|
| REQ-16 | Could    | Van stock tracking | Deferred to backlog |

## 6. Early benefit indicators (simulated, first 3 weeks)

*These are invented figures for a fictional company, included to show how benefits would be tracked. They are not real results.*

| Measure                              | Target             | Early indicator            | Next review    |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------|----------------|
| Enquiries logged in CRM              | 100%               | 100% from hypercare week 2 | Monthly report |
| Engineers using the mobile app daily | All 6 tablet users | 5 of 6                     | 3-month review |
| Quote turnaround                     | 2 working days     | 2.8 days average           | 3 and 6 months |
| Quotes followed up                   | 90%                | 84%                        | 3 and 6 months |
| Service reminders sent automatically | All due services   | Running since go-live      | 6 months       |

## 7. Handover and follow-on actions

- **R02 adoption risk:** transferred to Dave Pearson; usage report reviewed monthly.
- **Backlog:** two-way accounting sync (REQ-10), online booking portal (REQ-14), van stock tracking (REQ-16).
- **Benefits reviews:** at 3 and 6 months after go-live, owned by the sponsor.
- **Support:** supplier support contract and Priya Shah as internal system owner.

## 8. Lessons learned

| Theme                              | What happened                                                                                        | Impact                                                               | Recommendation                                                                               |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Data quality</b>                | Duplicates (I01) were found in week 8, after the plan was set.                                       | Cleansing took 20 days, not 10; go-live moved from 20 May to 27 May. | Run a data-quality sample during initiation and plan cleansing from evidence, not hope.      |
| <b>Supplier quotes</b>             | The accounting connector cost was not in the original quote (I02).                                   | £900 change request; two-way sync deferred.                          | Ask suppliers to confirm every integration in writing, with named versions, before contract. |
| <b>Engaging resistant users</b>    | Involving the Field Supervisor in designing the mobile screens turned early resistance into support. | Field engineer training went to plan; R02 eased.                     | Give the most sceptical stakeholder a design role early.                                     |
| <b>Baseline and tolerances</b>     | Agreeing a one-week time tolerance up front meant the slip was a managed decision, not a crisis.     | Sponsor approved the new date quickly at the go/no-go.               | Set time, cost and scope tolerances in the charter and report against them.                  |
| <b>Testing with real scenarios</b> | UAT scripts based on real job types caught the VAT rounding error (I04).                             | Fixed before go-live, with no customer impact.                       | Write UAT scripts from real past jobs, including awkward edge cases.                         |
| <b>Benefits</b>                    | Benefit measures were defined in the business case but baselines were rough estimates.               | Early results are indicative only.                                   | Measure the baseline (e.g. quote turnaround) before the project starts.                      |

## 9. Reflection (author's note)

I built this simulated project to practise, end to end, the methods I am studying in my MSc modules: a business case and options appraisal, PRINCE2-style governance and tolerances (Managing Projects with PRINCE2), probability-impact risk scoring (Risk Management in Projects), dependency-driven scheduling and visual reporting (Advanced Project Planning and Visualisation), and stakeholder engagement and adoption planning (The Management of

Change). The company, people and numbers are fictional. The point is the method and the consistency between artefacts, not the results.

10. Sign-off

| Role                    | Name         | Decision          | Date        |
|-------------------------|--------------|-------------------|-------------|
| Sponsor                 | Helen Marsh  | Project closed    | 16 Jun 2026 |
| Senior User / BAU owner | Dave Pearson | Accepted handover | 16 Jun 2026 |